

Pakistan



A populous and politically unstable Muslim state that was part of British India until 1947.

2600s BCE Indus valley civilization flourishes, building the great cities of Harappa and Mohenjo-Daro.

500 BCE Persian Achaemenid Empire stretches as far east as Indus river.

326 BCE Alexander the Great conquers Punjab region. The country is then ruled by the Seleucid Empire, the Mauryas, an Indo-Greek Bactrian kingdom, Scythian nomads, and the Parthians.

100s CE Kanishka dynasty of Kushan rulers control the country from their capital at Peshawar.

711 Muslim Arabs conquer Sindh, controlling most of northwest India by 900. The Ghaznavid Empire rules the region until 1186, when the empire is overthrown by Muhammad of Ghur, who conquers northern India. During the 13th century, the region falls under the control of the Muslim Sultanate of Delhi and, by 1600, the Mughal Empire.

1843 The British annex Sind province and, in 1846–49, the Punjab.

1857 Lahore, Peshawar, and other cities rise up against British rule during the Sepoy Rebellion.

1877 Most of present-day Pakistan becomes part of British India when Queen Victoria is made empress of India.

1893 The British settle the western frontier with Afghanistan along the Durand Line, bisecting Pashtun lands.

1897 More than 35,000 troops are needed by the British to quell an uprising by Pathan tribes in the northwest.

1901 British set up Northwest Frontier Province to try to contain rebellious tribes of the region.

1906 Muslim League founded as an organ of Indian Muslim separatism, to counter the all-India beliefs of the Indian National Congress.

1930 The poet Muhammad Iqbal introduces the idea of a Muslim nation distinct from Hindu India, an idea taken up by Indian Muslim students in Britain, who are the first to use the word Pakistan, meaning “land of the pure” in Urdu.

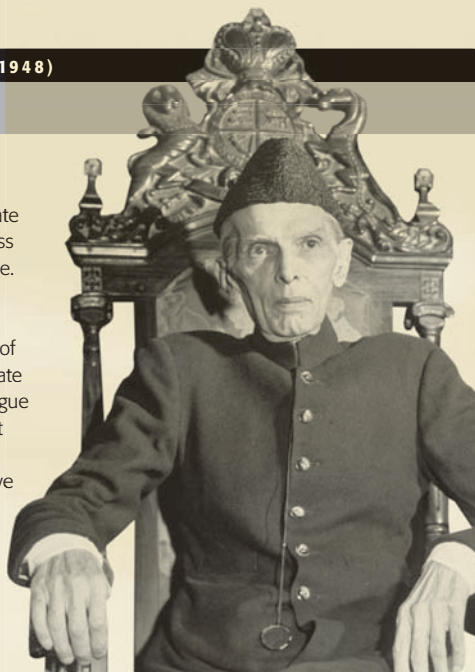
1940 Muslim League, led by Muhammad Ali Jinnah, demands a Muslim state in India in those areas where Muslims predominate. Three states in the northwest of India—Baluchistan, Northwest Frontier Province, and Sind—have huge Muslim majorities, while three more states—the Punjab in the west and Assam and Bengal in the east—are more

PAKISTANI STATESMAN (1876–1948)

MUHAMMAD ALI JINNAH

The founding father of Pakistan, Muhammad Ali Jinnah was a far-from-devout Muslim—he drank alcohol and ate pork—who had left the all-India Congress Party in 1934 to join the Muslim League. His aim was to campaign for a Muslim state in India.

In 1940 he led calls for the partition of India and the creation of the Muslim state of Pakistan. He cleverly aligned the League with Britain during World War II, but lost British support when he adopted direct action in 1946. He thus failed to achieve the six-province state he had wanted, but oversaw the independence of Pakistan when the British partitioned India on its independence in 1947. He served as first governor general of Pakistan, but died 13 months later.



evenly divided between Muslim and Hindu. Jinnah demands all six.

1944 Talks between Jinnah and Mahatma Gandhi on the future of India and its possible partition collapse.

1946 Muslim League wins most Muslim constituencies in elections. On August 16 Jinnah calls a direct action day in support of his demands, causing riots in Calcutta and elsewhere with at least 5,000 dead.

1947 Partition of India: the British viceroy of India, Lord Louis Mountbatten, announces the partition of India into largely Muslim and Hindu states: the state parliaments of Punjab and Bengal, and the Muslim Sylhet district of Assam, must decide which country to join or whether to partition themselves between the two. At independence on August 15, Pakistan is set up with Jinnah as the first governor general. Punjab and Bengal vote for partition; Sylhet votes to join Pakistan. Pakistan is thus created in two parts—East and West—separated by 994 miles (1,600 km) of Indian territory. Millions of Muslims and Hindus displaced by large-scale migration.



1948 First Indo-Pakistan war over Kashmir, a predominantly Muslim state whose Hindu ruler hesitated to join either new state at independence. Muslim tribesmen backed by Pakistan invade the state to force it to join Pakistan, prompting India to intervene. The two countries divide Kashmir between them.

1949 New Awami League (AL) demands East Bengal's autonomy. The proposed liberal constitution is opposed by orthodox Muslims, and the prime minister is assassinated in 1951.

1956 Constitution establishes Pakistan as an Islamic republic; East Bengal is now known as East Pakistan.

1958 Martial law: General Muhammad Ayyub Khan takes over. In 1962 he introduces a new constitution creating an Islamic republic with two provinces—West and East Pakistan—and two languages—Urdu and Bengali. The new city of Islamabad is made the capital.

1965 Second Indo-Pakistan war over Kashmir and the disputed Rann of Kutch.

1970 Ayyub Khan resigns as General Agha Yahya Khan takes over. First direct elections won by Awami League; West Pakistani parties reject results, leading to a military crackdown in East Pakistan.

1971 East Pakistan secedes as Bangladesh. Pakistan People's Party (PPP) leader Zulfikar Ali Bhutto is president.

1972 Simla peace agreement with India commits the two countries “to settle their differences by peaceful means.”

War with India

The two nations have gone to war twice over Kashmir, and once over Bangladesh. These Pakistani troops fought in the second war over Kashmir in 1965.

1973 Bhutto, now prime minister, initiates Islamic socialism.

1977 General election causes riots over allegations of vote rigging; General Zia ul-Haq stages a military coup.

1979 Bhutto is executed after being found guilty of ordering the murder of a political opponent.

1986 Bhutto's daughter Benazir returns from exile to lead PPP.

1988 Zia is killed in a plane crash. Benazir Bhutto wins general election.

1990 President dismisses Benazir Bhutto. Nawaz Sharif becomes prime minister.

1991 Muslim sharia law incorporated in legal code.

1993 President Khan and Prime Minister Sharif resign. After elections, Benazir Bhutto returns to power.

1996 President dismisses Bhutto again.

1997 Pakistan Muslim League wins landslide election victory; Nawaz Sharif elected prime minister.

1998 Nuclear tests are carried out as Pakistan acquires nuclear weapons.

1999 Military coup by General Pervez Musharraf; Sharif is found guilty of treason and exiled. Serious clashes with Indian troops around Kargil in Kashmir.

2001 National assembly suspended; Musharraf appoints himself president. A referendum in 2002 allows him to hold power until 2007.

2001 US-led invasion of Afghanistan places Pakistan in frontline of the international “war on terror.”

2003 Relations with India improve; the leaders of both nations hold talks in 2005.

2005 An earthquake in Kashmir leaves thousands dead.

2007 Benazir Bhutto, standing in presidential elections, is assassinated. Pervez Musharraf is elected for second presidential term.

2008 Opposition parties win a clear majority in parliamentary elections. Ali Asif Zardari, the widower of Benazir Bhutto, is elected president.

2009 The government agrees to implement Sharia law in northwestern Swat valley to head off increasing militant control there. After this fails, the government launches offensive in Swat. The Pakistani Taliban leader Baitullah Mehsud is killed by a US drone attack.

2010 The worst flood in 80 years leads to over 1,500 deaths.

«78–79 Bronze Age Collapse
«410–11 The Partition of India